Guadalcanal and the Solomon Islands

The American and Japanese forces fought for control of the Solomon Islands because they were situated close to the important shipping routes used by the Allies. Between 1942 and 1943, the Allies invaded Guadalcanal Island. This island was so close to the Solomon Islands that the Japanese were forced to withdraw from the Solomon Islands. At the same time, India and Britain were fighting Japan in Burma, which is located in modern day Myanmar.